JOSHUA BEHYMER

Client Advocacy | Resource Navigation | Case Management & Service Coordination
Kalamazoo, MI | (269) 552-8234 | Joshua.behymer@outlook.com | linkedin.com/in/joshuabehymer
Empathy | **Woo** | **Positivity** | **Individualization** | **Developer**

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Client advocate and service coordinator with 10 years of one-on-one work in Kalamazoo and Southwest Michigan, helping people facing justice involvement, mental illness, disability, houselessness, and poverty navigate complex systems and reach their own goals. Builds trusting relationships, develops individualized plans, and coordinates with parole and probation, drug court teams, community mental health, state agencies, and employers, with steady follow-through and accurate documentation. Trained in Mental Health First Aid and Mandt System de-escalation.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Deaf and Hard of Hearing Accommodation Specialist — Western Michigan University | August 2024 – Present

- Manage a full student accommodation caseload: meet with students to understand their needs and barriers, develop individualized accommodation plans, coordinate with faculty and campus offices, and maintain confidential records.
- Coordinate ASL interpreters, Sighted Aides, and accessible transportation for students with disabilities; supervise and schedule 20+ interpreters, drivers, and aides around needs and priorities that shift throughout the day.
- Co-created **BroncoNav**, WMU's accessible campus shuttle, with Dr. Zach Asher's lab to remove a transportation barrier for students; now manage all operations. 1,500+ rides in its first full semester.
- Built a working partnership with WMU's **Higher Education for Justice Impacted (HEJI)** initiative; co-authoring a joint capital infrastructure proposal that consolidates two funding requests into one shared project.
- Serve as DSS's official liaison to the **Bureau of Services for Blind Persons (BSBP)** and coordinate WMU's role in the BSBP Summer Transition Program for blind and low-vision high school students.

Employment Services and Transitions Coordinator — OnPoint, Allegan, MI | November 2021 – June 2024

- Coordinated services for **justice-impacted participants** alongside parole and probation officers and drug court teams, so each person's employment plan supported the requirements of their case; managed contract compliance and performance reporting.
- As sole community liaison for OnPoint, Allegan County's community mental health agency, coordinated Michigan Rehabilitation Services, Michigan Works!, community mental health, school districts, and employers around each person's goals.
- Directed the **Youth Transitions** program, building individualized transition plans with students, families, school districts, and funding agencies for the move from high school into work and/or higher education.

Employment Training Specialist II — MRC Industries, Kalamazoo, MI | May 2017 – November 2021

- Supported **hundreds of job seekers** facing significant barriers, including mental illness, disability, justice involvement, and houselessness, from first meeting through job placement and ongoing follow-along support.
- Served as internal expert trainer on **Individual Placement and Support (IPS)**, the evidence-based supported employment model that integrates employment services with each person's mental health treatment team; led CARF accreditation preparation and continuous quality improvement.
- Built and maintained 50+ regional employer partnerships that gave clients real options across tech, agriculture, manufacturing, healthcare, and more.
- Kept accurate, timely client records in Salesforce CRM and built the department-wide tracking and reporting process used to measure outcomes against program goals.

Job Developer — Gateway Services (now Center for Growth and Independence), Kalamazoo, MI | 2016 – 2017

- Partnered with parole officers and drug court teams to connect justice-impacted job seekers to employment.

EDUCATION & RECOGNITION

Master of Public Administration, Western Michigan University — December 2026
Bachelor of Science, University Studies, Western Michigan University (Kalamazoo Promise Scholar)
Mental Health First Aid | Mandt System De-escalation | Individual Placement and Support (IPS) |
Benefits to Work Coach | Salesforce CRM | CARF Accreditation | WMU Accessibility Champion (2025)